

ANSWER KEY

Baton Certification — BSIS Written Examination

Instructor Copy — Retain Securely

33 Questions (24 Official BSIS Exam + 9 Supplemental) | Pass: 20/24 + All 7 Vital Areas | BPC §§7583.33 | 7585.9 | 7585.13

VITAL AREAS — REQUIRED ANSWERS (All 7 Must Be Identified)

Student must correctly identify ALL 7 areas. Failure to identify any one area = exam failure, regardless of written score.

- | | | |
|----------|---|--|
| A | Head (temple, skull, jaw) | Strikes can cause brain injury, skull fracture, or death |
| B | Throat / Neck (carotid, trachea) | Strikes can cause asphyxiation, cardiac arrest, or death |
| C | Spine (cervical, thoracic, lumbar) | Strikes can cause permanent paralysis or death |
| D | Kidneys (posterior lower back) | Organ rupture, internal bleeding, shock |
| E | Groin | Severe injury, nerve damage, shock |
| F | Sternum / Solar Plexus | Cardiac arrhythmia, respiratory arrest |
| G | Knees (joint area) | Permanent structural damage, disability |

OFFICIAL BSIS EXAM — 24 QUESTIONS — QUICK ANSWER REFERENCE

Pass: 20/24

Q1 D	Q2 B	Q3 D	Q4 T	Q5 B	Q6 C
Q7 C	Q8 B	Q9 C	Q10 F	Q11 F	Q12 T
Q13 F	Q14 T	Q15 F	Q16 F	Q17 T	Q18 T
Q19 F	Q20 T	Q21 T	Q22 F	Q23 T	Q24 T

1 ★

Legal Responsibility

BPC §7583.33 | PC §22001

If you use your baton, you should remember that you might be required to justify your actions in:

- A. Criminal court only
- C. To your employer only

B. Civil court only

✓ D. All of the above — criminal court, civil court, and to your employer

D

2 ★

Vital Areas

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5

A baton strike to the head, throat, or spine:

- A. Is usually fatal
- C. Always causes paralysis

✓ B. Could be fatal

D. Is always fatal

B

3 ★

Permit Requirements

BPC §7583.33 | PC §22001

A guard who carries a baton without a baton permit may be:

- A. Fined \$100 by the Bureau for the first offense
- C. Charged with a criminal violation of Penal Code §22001 (formerly §12020(a)), which is a felony

B. Fined \$200 by the Bureau for the second and all future offenses

✓ D. All of the above

D

4 ★

Continuing Education

BSIS Baton Policy

The Bureau encourages continuous baton training so that you may carry the baton with confidence to effectively and legally defend yourself.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

5 ★

Use of Force — Target Areas

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5

During a non-life-threatening situation, the baton should not be used to strike above the:

A. Waist

✓ B. Shoulders

C. Groin

D. Knees

B

6 ★

PPO Liability

BPC §7585.19

If a private patrol operator allows you to carry a baton before you complete baton training and receive a baton permit, the company may be fined by the Bureau in the amount of:

A. \$100

B. \$300

✓ C. \$2,500

D. Nothing — the PPO's license is automatically revoked

C

De-escalation

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 2

7 ★

When you are first confronted with a situation that could escalate, you should first consider:

- A. Arresting the suspect without getting hurt
- ✓ C. Remaining calm and attempting to control the situation by talking to the person
- B. Looking for a telephone to call for help
- D. Finding a witness

C

Tactical Response

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 2

8 ★

A man somewhat smaller than you is having an argument with your client and it looks like the situation is escalating. You should first:

- A. Tell the man he has 10 seconds to leave
- ✓ B. Make your presence known and be prepared to act defensively
- C. Call the police and tell them you have a suspect under surveillance
- D. Draw your baton out of the ring and tap it in the palm of your hand

B

Use of Force Decision

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 2

9 ★

Which factor would you NOT consider when deciding whether to use your baton?

- A. Size of the subject
- ✓ C. Whether you will have to make a report
- B. Whether the subject may be under the influence of drugs
- D. Whether the subject is armed

C

10 ★

*Off-Duty Carry**BPC §7583.33*

When you are not on duty, you may wear your baton as long as you have your baton permit in your possession.

T. True

✓ F. False

F

11 ★

*Permit Types**BPC §7583.33*

You may carry a baton on duty as long as you have a firearms permit in your possession.

T. True

✓ F. False

F

12 ★

*Legal Definitions**PC §242*

Battery is any willful and unlawful use of force or violence upon another person.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

13 ★

*Baton Purpose**BSIS Baton Manual Preface***The baton is an offensive weapon.**

T. True

✓ F. False

F

14 ★

*Vital Areas**BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5***The head, spine, and kidneys are vital areas to be avoided when using a baton, unless there is a deadly attack on you or another person.**

✓ T. True

F. False

T

15 ★

*Registration Requirement**BPC §7583.33 | BPC §7585.14***You may carry a baton on duty without a security guard registration in your possession.**

T. True

✓ F. False

F

16 ★

*Justification for Force**BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 2*

You are escorting an unruly rock concert patron to the exit. He screams and insults you, using profanity. You would be justified in jabbing him with your baton.

T. True

✓ F. False

F

17 ★

*Use of Force — Proportionality**BPC §7583.7 | Objectively Reasonable Standard*

You should meet physical force with only that amount of force reasonable to defend yourself and control the situation.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

18 ★

*Suspension Procedures**BPC §7583.15*

If you use too much force with your baton and the Director of the Department of Consumer Affairs determines that you are a hazard to public safety, your permit may be suspended and your employer will be notified of the suspension.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

19 ★

Legal Definitions

Tort Law | Civil Liability

Criminal liability means you have to pay damages after being sued.

T. True

✓ F. False

F

20 ★

Employer Reporting

BPC §7583.2

If you are arrested after using your baton in a physical altercation, your employer must report the incident to the Bureau within seven days.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

21 ★

In-House Guard Requirements

BPC §7585.14

In-house or proprietary guards are required to have both a guard card and baton permit if they carry a baton on duty.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

22 ★

*Deadly Force Limits**BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 2 | PC §22001*

If someone trespasses onto property that you are protecting, you would be justified in using deadly force.

T. True

✓ F. False

F

23 ★

*Training Practices**BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5*

Practicing baton techniques in front of a mirror is a good idea.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

24 ★

*Baton Carry Side**BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5*

A baton may be carried on your weak or your strong side.

✓ T. True

F. False

T

25

Permit Validity

BSIS Baton Fact Sheet 2024

How long is a BSIS Baton Permit valid before renewal is required?

- A. 1 year
- ✓ B. 2 years — permit now expires and requires renewal
- C. Baton permits do not expire
- D. 5 years

B

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Permit Issuance

BPC §7585.14

A BSIS Baton Permit may be issued by:

- A. Any BSIS-licensed Private Patrol Operator
- ✓ C. A BSIS-certified Baton Training Facility with a certified instructor on site
- B. The BSIS Bureau directly to the guard via mail
- D. Any BSIS-approved security guard instructor

C

27

Roster Requirements

BPC §7585.14(c)

After completing a baton training class, a baton training facility must submit a roster of students to BSIS within:

- A. 24 hours
- ✓ C. 5 working days
- B. 3 working days
- D. 30 days

C

28

Exam Requirements

BSIS Baton Manual Admin. Procedures

To pass the BSIS baton written examination, a student must:

A. Score 100% on all 24 questions

C. Score at least 20 out of 24 — vital areas are optional

✓ **B. Score at least 20 out of 24 AND correctly identify all vital areas of body**

D. Score at least 18 out of 24

B

29

Training Facility

BPC §7585.3 | BPC §7585.11

To legally teach and certify the full BSIS baton permit course, a business entity must hold:

A. Only a standard PPO license

C. Any BSIS security training approval

✓ **B. A BSIS Baton Training Facility (TFB) certificate and employ a certified baton instructor**

D. A firearms training facility certificate (TFF) which includes baton authorization

B

30

Force Justification

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 2

Baton use is justified against a subject who is:

A. Verbally abusive but not physically threatening

✓ **C. Actively physically aggressive and posing an imminent threat of serious bodily injury**

B. Passively refusing to leave private property

D. Trespassing and refusing to answer questions

C

31

Vital Areas

BSIS Baton Manual Ch. 5

Strikes to vital areas of the body may ONLY be justified when:

- A. The subject is larger than the guard
- B. The guard is in any physical confrontation
- ✓ D. The guard or another person faces imminent death or serious bodily injury
- C. The subject is actively resisting arrest

D

32

Record Retention

BPC §7585.15

Under BPC §7585.15, baton training answer sheets must be retained by the training facility for at least:

- A. 6 months
- B. 1 year
- ✓ C. 2 years
- D. 5 years

C

33

MACCESS INC. PPO

PPO License #122729

MACCESS INC.'s California Private Patrol Operator license number, which must appear on all BSIS Certificates of Completion, is:

- A. #112233
- B. #100001
- ✓ D. #122729
- C. #133445

D

SCORING GUIDE & INSTRUCTOR OBLIGATIONS

Written Pass Score

20 out of 24 official questions — partial credit not awarded

Vital Areas Pass

ALL 7 vital areas correctly identified — failure to name any one = exam failure

Both Required

Student must pass BOTH components simultaneously. Passing one does not hold.

Re-Test

Allowed at instructor's discretion. Failing score must be recorded before re-test.

Answer Sheets

Retain for minimum 2 years per BPC §7585.15 — available to BSIS on request

★ = Official BSIS Q

Questions marked ★ are from the official BSIS Baton Training Written Examination

Permit Issuance

BSIS Baton Permit issued by certified instructor at BSIS-certified TFB only (not PPO alone)

Roster

Submit roster to BSIS within 5 working days of class completion (BPC §7585.14)